# Vagan Manukian
# User experience + communication designer

9+ years of product and visual design experience
with focus on empathy and front-end

## 💼 Employment History

### Senior Product Designer / Design Lead at AliExpress

Sep 2023 – Sep 2025

I was responsible for the design of the shopping cart, and later led design for the broader Personal Zone (checkout, profile, orders) on a platform with 35M+ MAU in Russia.

Full Cart redesign with onboarding, “Save for later”, “Buy Now” actions and coupon mechanics
Cart-to-checkout conversion +6.9%
Buyer conversion +1.7%
GMV from cart recommendations +49%

Profile: passport data collection (manual & automated) and unified communications across login, PDP, orders, checkout
Passport completeness 67% → 80%

Checkout: streamlined address handling and order creation
Checkout-to-order conversion +5.7%
Average items per order +4.9%

**Beyond core scope**
Product cards (platform-wide): initiated and contributed to redesign improving information hierarchy, price/promo clarity, and visual consistency across listings
Conversion 2.2% → 6.7%
Success rate 62% → 87%

**Beyond core scope**
Bundle-deals sales channel (internal “Combo/Choice”): designed a dedicated cart with mandatory threshold logic and a cross-page progress bar; co-created the channel’s visual identity (logo, “combo” metaphor, KO-style visuals); improved navigation and supported design across the full flow
Conversion 2.2% → 6.7%
Success rate 62% → 87%
Choice Order Adoption +2.2%
Payments +3.1%
UV value +2.9%

### Founder / Product Designer at UniBag

Dec 2022 – June 2023

Developed a browser extension (with mobile app concept) that allowed users to save products across stores, track prices and availability, apply promo codes, and complete checkout with one click.

I was responsible for product vision, UX/UI design, and early prototyping.

### Senior communication designer at Yandex Fintech unit

Jan 2022 – Apr 2022

Crafting scalable promo pages for launching and testing new products for 100 000+ people. Creating visual identity of fintech products. Delievering new marketing content with external collaborators. Art-directing and producing physical products for internal team usage.

### Interface and communication consultant at SmallTalk

Sep 2020 – May 2021

Developed clean branding and modular interface for spoken English educational platform based on AI.

Together with English teachers we dived into language learning processes and developed different exercise modes to make the product as unique and useful as possible.

For the exercises’ key visuals we used AI-generated faces which allowed us to give each lesson unique appearence and make them feel like a real conversation when you look at persons eyes.

### Freelance projects

Oct 2019 – Jan 2022

Have been working as an independent designer on various e-commerce projects providing UX/UI expertise and digital art-direction.

### Junior to Senior designer at WRS Design Studio

Aug 2017 – Oct 2019

Conceptualizing, prototyping and testing design for Web desktop/mobile and iOS apps.

Showcasing design concepts to client and maintaining efficient communication throughout the project.

Art-directing 3D artists and illustrators for additional design needs.

Working hand-to-hand with engineers providing guidance on all stages of development in order to keep pixel perfect design delivery.

### Product designer and digital art-director at Madfrenzy

2017 – Present

Madfrenzy is a London based fashion brand with unusual approach to a daily wear and I had a pleasure to work together since 2017.

As a part of a team I participated in market analysis, user research and usability testings, content creation, UX copywriting and special marketing web-projects.

Main features:
Bread crumbs stylized navigation, photo oriented product page with split screen for both men and women.

Automated size recommendation system with interactive WebGL gender-neutral model that changes its proportions when adjusting your size (to increase engagement).

Sliders on items in collections for a quick product view and a lot of tiny references complementing brands «From Office Chair To Mountain Air» concept.

## 🎓 Education

### National University of Science and Technology Applied Informatics Master Degree

SKILLS

| | |
|---|---|
| Product Design | Interaction Design |
| UX/UI Design | CJM |
| Design Systems | Creative Coding |
| Communication Design | JavaScript |
| Prototyping | WebGL |
| Wireframing | HTML5 |
| Figma | CSS3 |
| Adobe Creative Suite | User-centered design |

vaganmanukian.com

Currently in Yerevan